

Assertive Communication Tool

Passive, Aggressive, and Assertive Communication

Passive Communication

During passive communication, a person prioritizes the needs, wants, and feelings of others, even at their own expense. The person does not express their own needs, or does not stand up for them. This can lead to being taken advantage of, even by well-meaning people who are unaware of the passive communicator's needs and wants.

- Soft spoken/quiet
- Allows others to take advantage
- Prioritizes needs of others
- Poor eye contact/looks down or away
- Does not express one's own needs or wants
- Lack of confidence

Aggressive Communication

Through aggressive communication, a person expresses that only their own needs, wants, and feelings matter. The other person is bullied, and their needs are ignored.

- Easily frustrated
- Use of criticism, humiliation, and domination
- Speaks in a loud or overbearing way
- Frequently interrupts or does not listen
- Unwilling to compromise
- Disrespectful toward others

Assertive Communication

Assertive communication emphasizes the importance of both peoples' needs. During assertive communication, a person stands up for their own needs, wants, and feelings, but also listens to and respects the needs of others. Assertive communication is defined by confidence, and a willingness to compromise.

- Listens without interruption
- Clearly states needs and wants
- Willing to compromise
- Stands up for own rights
- Confident tone I body language
- Good eye contact